

Live / Exhaustion Based Fighting System

The core of the system: Tactical Combat based around constant cost of your main resources:

Life and Stamina

The core: Every action will drain your limited stamina bar, which are used for every action

Example: Dodge an attack "a number of Stamina will be subtracted regardless of success, but failing will also lower your HP"

Your character will become weaker the less HP They have, half of the HP bar will have a character with different stats and different skills, some born from desperation.

We will have a bar divided in the middle, this middle means death, in the left we have life and right stamina.

Each bar will have sections "character specific" example: 100% percent 60% percent and 20% percent.

At 100% Stamina you can use certain abilities, like a backflip slash, this will waste your stamina and nothing else at 60% stamina you can use an inferior version of the attack, but at 20% you will use your healthy to perform the action risking your life.

This will allow the player to experiment with their stamina but really takes things seriously when it comes to their HP.

The HP will also have you deal with negative effects but more drastically, like losing more stamina, being easier to poison, you become a prey at low healthy, the HP will also be extremely hard to heal, this will ensure every combat becomes important because you can waste your stamina and simply rest, while your healthy is much more sacred.

Key components

The cost will always be high You will always use stamina for everything and your HP becomes a secondary but equally important resource, that you will play around, if the stamina reaches zero you will die just like your health, meaning sometimes you need to lose to healthy and keep your stamina because of your poor planning.

NO MAGIC BAR

there will be no magic bar, for the stamina and HP will dictate each of the skills you can use, skills being tagged with a certain percentage of your bar (This skill can only be used with more than 50% percent of Stamina) when either criteria is not met you won't be able to perform an action or perform an inferior version of the action.

Examples:

5 stamina to perform an uppercut. (Uppercut will do 5 damage and will instantly KO a Dizzy opponent)

(100% Stamina) costs 5 stamina:

is a success "5 damage vs the opponent's defense and will KO if the opponent has the Dizzy state".

(60% Stamina) will have a weaker effect: "3 damage and 50% Chance KO

(20% Stamina) for this one you will need to put 15 healthy points as a desperation attempt, pushing your body

2 Damage and 50% chance KO

Statistics they are the numbers that quantify your attributes and will work in conjunction with your skills

Stamina or Exhaustion: The number that will allow you to perform actions, can be recovered from not doing anything or using some special skills, if it reaches zero you will die or faint.

Healthy: equally important as your stamina, it's damaged on critical or surprise attacks, poison, wounds hurt your healthy instead of stamina, your health can be used to perform actions but it's extremely hard to recover health.

Both Healthy and Stamina are divided in numbers and your other stats and skills suffer from those stats becoming smaller.

Speed: a number that will determine your turn in combat, in short who acts first, enough speed will make you able to act multiple times before an enemy can respond

Agility: the speed in which you perform actions or defend yourself, dodge being its main mechanic, but also allowing you to defeat an enemy's dodge by being faster than them.

Defense: Subtraction of damage

Example: 4 damage vs 1 defense equals 3 damage pierced

Resistances: More specific way to measure resistance, unlike defense the results can be zero or negative example:

Poison: resistance: It will subtract the chance to be affected by it

Example: if poison resistance is 3, and you take 1 poison damage the resistance will become 2, your overall defense will be lowered with every interaction.

Immunity: No damage from this interaction, or subtraction as you can't be affected.

Absorbing: You will be healed instead of damaged by the interaction.

Skills can give you these resistances in combat, but other skills can weaken you or take away those resistances entirely.

The core of the gameplay is disabling, the decision making of what to attack and why, using your Stamina mostly but also seeing that sometimes you need to give up your health, as stamina can also kill you if it reaches zero.

After looking in many games I realized what I wanted with the limb system was more depth, the limb system can do that, but also brings much annoyance with pacing of the combat, sure hitting the face should blind someone, but why make a limb system when we can simply give the player a skill to hit the eye and a "blind condition" to the enemy, or hit the leg and make the opponent limp as a condition, much easier to code and more straightforward.

Players want consistent and predictable results, the limb system brings too much ifs and buts, that have a lot of conditions, while having a percentage % of your HP and Stamina that if you use there will be consequences, while also punishing is much more straightforward and predictable.

Health being rather limited solves many classic RPG problems, as you will have many ways to be severely punished and incentivised to swap party members, and not steam roll weaker enemies without a plan for every HP damage point counts.